

Jongwon Lim

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

My research focuses on **using interpretability to improve how we actually use and develop foundation models**. I am exploring two complementary directions:

1. Understanding model capabilities and limitations

- How does machine intelligence fundamentally differ from human intelligence? [Negation]
- What are the capabilities and limitations of foundation models in practice? [Dual mechanisms]

2. Understanding model training

- How does training reshape a model's internal computation? [VLA RL]
- How can we integrate insights from interpretability into training algorithms/pipelines? [POISE], [Negation]

EDUCATION

Seoul National University

2025 - Present

Ph.D. in Data Science, Graduate School of Data Science. Advised by Yohan Jo at HOLI Lab.

Seoul National University

2019 - 2025

B.A. in Linguistics and Data Science for Humanities

AWARDS

Research Scholarship

2025.09 - 2026.08

National Research Foundation of Korea (NRF)

Outstanding Bachelor's Thesis

2024

Evaluating the Understanding of Blend Morphology in Large Language Models

PUBLICATIONS

* Equal contribution

Your Language Model is Its Own Critic: Reinforcement Learning with Value Estimation from Actor's Internal States

Yunho Choi*, **Jongwon Lim***, Woojin Ahn, Minjae Oh, Jeonghoon Shim, Yohan Jo

NeurIPS 2026 Poster [arXiv] [Project page]

ArcANE: Do Role-Playing Language Agents Stay in Character at the Right Time?

Woojung Song, Nalim Kim, Sangjun Song, Chaewon Heo, **Jongwon Lim**, Yohan Jo

EMNLP 2026 Main [arXiv]

Dual Mechanisms of Value Expression: Intrinsic vs. Prompted Values in Large Language Models

Jongwook Han*, **Jongwon Lim***, Injin Kong, Yohan Jo

ICML 2026 Regular [arXiv] [Project page] [OpenReview]

Learning to Retrieve User History and Generate User Profiles for Personalized Persuasiveness Prediction

Sejun Park, Yoonah Park, **Jongwon Lim**, Yohan Jo

ACL 2026 Findings [arXiv]

PREPRINTS

* Equal contribution

How Do LLMs Change Predictions Under Negation?

Jongwook Yoon*, **Jongwon Lim***, Sungjib Lim, Woojin Cho, Yohan Jo

Preprint (under review) [arXiv]

The Low-Rank Structure of VLA Reinforcement Learning

Minjae Oh*, Yoonah Park*, **Jongwon Lim***, Yohan Jo

Preprint (under review) [arXiv]

How Language Models Compute Negation: A Mechanistic Study of Factual Negation

Jongwook Yoon, **Jongwon Lim**, Yohan Jo

Mech Interp Workshop @ ICML 2026 [OpenReview] [PDF] [Poster]

DAHL: Domain-specific Automated Hallucination Evaluation of Long-Form Text through a Benchmark Dataset in Biomedicine

Jean Seo, **Jongwon Lim**, Dongjun Jang, Hyopil Shin

FEVER Workshop @ EMNLP 2024 [arXiv] [Code]

TEACHING

Teaching Assistant

Fall 2026

Seoul National University. Course: AI at Work (Data Science Seminar).

Teaching Assistant

Spring 2026

Seoul National University. Course: Large Language Models and Conversational AI.

SERVICES

Conference Reviewer

ICLR 2027

Workshop Reviewer

- Pluralistic Alignment Workshop @ ICML 2026
- Mechanistic Interpretability Workshop @ ICML 2026 · also emergency reviewer
- 3rd AI for Math Workshop @ ICML 2026
- BlackboxNLP Workshop @ EMNLP 2026
- Interpretability for Discovery Workshop @ NeurIPS 2026 · also emergency reviewer
- Transitioning from Pre-Training to Post-Training Workshop @ NeurIPS 2026

Mentor, 3rd LG AI Youth Camp

2026

Mentored student participants on AI projects and research-oriented problem solving.

EXPERIENCES

Research Intern, CL_NLP Lab, Seoul National University

Oct 2023 - Sep 2024

Language model training and evaluation, retrieval-augmented generation, experiments, analysis, and academic writing.

Head Researcher, SNU Faculty of Liberal Education

May 2024 - Dec 2024

Benchmark dataset for evaluating morphological capabilities of large language models.

Kaggle Silver Medalist, LLM - Detect AI-generated Text

Jan 2024 - Mar 2024

Built ensemble systems for AI-generated text detection.

Military Service, Republic of Korea Army

Apr 2021 - Sep 2022

Instructor for armored vehicle operation at the Republic of Korea Army Armor School.